

RAMCO VIDYA MANDIR SR. SEC. SCHOOL, THAMARAIKULAM
CLASS 12 ENGLISH REVISION – SR 2 THE TIGER KING

Marks :

Name :

Duration :

Exam No. :

Section A: Extract Based Comprehension (3 x 5 = 15 marks)

Passage 1

"At the time of birth, astrologers predicted that the prince would someday die due to a tiger. The little prince, barely ten days old, raised a challenge, asking how he would die if he killed all the tigers himself."

Questions:

1. What does the astrologer's prediction signify in the story?
2. How does the prince's reaction to the prophecy reflect his personality?
3. **MCQ:** What was the prince's response to the prophecy?
 - A) He ignored it completely
 - B) He challenged it, showing defiance
 - C) He feared it and avoided tigers
 - D) He sought blessings for protection
4. **Assertion (A):** The prince was destined to die due to a tiger. **Reason (R):** His kingdom was known for its large tiger population.
 - A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
 - C) A is true, but R is false
 - D) A is false, but R is true
5. **Choose the correct word to complete the sentence:** The prince exhibited _____ by mocking the astrologer's prediction.
 - A) bravery
 - B) cowardice
 - C) ignorance
 - D) obedience

Passage 2

"The Maharaja vowed to kill one hundred tigers to prove the prophecy wrong. He declared that no one else in the kingdom was allowed to hunt tigers, and anyone defying the order would lose their wealth and privileges."

Questions:

1. How did the Maharaja attempt to defy the prophecy?
2. What does his strict hunting rule reveal about his character?
3. **MCQ:** What was the consequence of hunting tigers in the kingdom?
 - A) A reward from the king
 - B) A royal pardon

- C) Loss of wealth and privileges
 - D) Promotion in the kingdom
4. **Assertion (A):** The Maharaja became obsessed with tiger hunting. **Reason (R):** He wanted to prove the prophecy wrong and ensure his safety.
- A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
 - C) A is true, but R is false
 - D) A is false, but R is true
5. **Choose the correct word to complete the sentence:** The Maharaja was driven by his desire to _____ the prophecy.
- A) fulfill
 - B) avoid
 - C) challenge
 - D) ignore

Passage 3

"The hundredth tiger, which was meant to seal the prophecy, was never actually killed by the king. An old, feeble tiger had been spared, while the Maharaja believed he had completed his vow."

Questions:

1. How does the irony in this passage contribute to the theme of the story?
2. What role did fate play in the Maharaja's ultimate demise?
3. **MCQ:** What was the truth about the hundredth tiger?
 - A) It was never killed by the king
 - B) It was the strongest of all
 - C) It was shot by a hunter
 - D) It ran away from the kingdom
4. **Assertion (A):** The Maharaja unknowingly failed to fulfill his vow. **Reason (R):** His men ensured that he believed the hundredth tiger was dead.
 - A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A
 - B) Both A and R are true, but R does not explain A
 - C) A is true, but R is false
 - D) A is false, but R is true
5. **Choose the correct word to complete the sentence:** The Maharaja met his end due to _____.
 - A) coincidence
 - B) prophecy
 - C) luck
 - D) deception

Answer Key:

Passage 1

Answers:

1. The astrologer's prediction symbolizes fate and irony in the story, foreshadowing the Maharaja's ultimate demise.
2. The prince's reaction reflects his arrogance and defiance. Instead of fearing the prophecy, he challenges it, demonstrating his stubborn nature.
3. **Correct Answer:** B) He challenged it, showing defiance
4. **Correct Answer:** C) A is true, but R is false **Explanation:** The prince was indeed destined to die due to a tiger, but the kingdom's tiger population was not the reason for his death.
5. **Correct Answer:** A) Bravery **Explanation:** The prince's decision to challenge the prophecy reveals his boldness, though it also leads to his downfall.

Passage 2

Answers:

1. The Maharaja attempted to defy the prophecy by systematically hunting tigers, believing that eliminating them would prevent his foretold death.
2. His strict hunting rule reveals his obsessive nature and authoritative rule over his subjects.
3. **Correct Answer:** C) Loss of wealth and privileges
4. **Correct Answer:** A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A **Explanation:** The Maharaja's obsession with tiger hunting stemmed from his fear of the prophecy, which dictated his actions.
5. **Correct Answer:** C) Challenge **Explanation:** The Maharaja was determined to prove the prophecy wrong by taking drastic measures.

Passage 3

Answers:

1. The irony of this passage emphasizes the theme of fate. The Maharaja believed he had escaped his destiny, but the truth ensured that the prophecy would still be fulfilled.
2. Fate played a crucial role in his downfall—despite his attempts to cheat destiny, he met his end because of an unnoticed mistake.
3. **Correct Answer:** A) It was never killed by the king
4. **Correct Answer:** A) Both A and R are true, and R explains A **Explanation:** The Maharaja was misled into believing he had killed the hundredth tiger, allowing his destiny to take its course.
5. **Correct Answer:** B) Prophecy **Explanation:** The Maharaja ultimately met his end as the prophecy had predicted, despite all his efforts to prevent it.

Section B: Short Answer Questions (12 x 2 = 24 marks)

Story-Based Questions (3)

1. **Why was the Maharaja named *The Tiger King*?**

- **Answer:** He earned the title because he set out to kill 100 tigers to defy the prophecy that predicted his death by a tiger.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for mentioning prophecy
 - 1 mark for explaining his obsession with hunting

2. How did the Maharaja react to the astrologer's prediction?

- **Answer:** He mocked the astrologer and challenged the prophecy, saying he would kill all tigers himself.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for mentioning mockery
 - 1 mark for explaining his challenge

3. How did the Maharaja's desire to fulfill his vow affect his rule?

- **Answer:** He imposed strict laws banning others from killing tigers and used his royal authority solely to achieve his goal.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for explaining law enforcement
 - 1 mark for highlighting his obsession

Value-Based Questions (3)

4. What lesson does *The Tiger King* teach about arrogance and fate?

- **Answer:** It shows that arrogance can blind a person to reality, and fate plays an inevitable role in life.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for discussing arrogance
 - 1 mark for explaining fate

5. How does the story reflect the environmental consequences of hunting?

- **Answer:** The Maharaja's excessive hunting led to the endangerment of tigers, highlighting the reckless destruction of wildlife.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for connecting hunting to extinction
 - 1 mark for emphasizing environmental impact

6. What social message does the story convey about blind superstition?

- **Answer:** It criticizes how people blindly follow predictions, often making irrational choices that lead to their downfall.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for discussing superstition
 - 1 mark for linking it to the Maharaja's actions

Competency-Based Questions (4)

7. How did the Maharaja ensure he killed exactly 100 tigers?

- **Answer:** He counted each kill carefully and manipulated circumstances to hunt more when needed.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for mentioning careful tracking

- 1 mark for explaining manipulation

8. Why was the Maharaja unaware that the hundredth tiger was not actually killed by him?

- **Answer:** His men, fearing his wrath, ensured he believed he had completed his vow by not correcting his mistake.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for explaining the deception
 - 1 mark for mentioning his ignorance

9. How did the astrologer's prophecy ultimately come true?

- **Answer:** The Maharaja was killed by a wooden tiger's splinter, ironically fulfilling the prediction.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for mentioning the wooden tiger
 - 1 mark for highlighting irony

10. Why did the Maharaja reject British officers' request for tiger hunting?

- **Answer:** He feared it would prevent him from reaching his goal of killing 100 tigers himself.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for stating refusal
 - 1 mark for explaining his motive

Literary Device-Based Questions (2)

11. Identify and explain the irony in the Maharaja's death.

- **Answer:** The irony lies in the fact that he killed numerous tigers to avoid his foretold death, but was ultimately killed by a wooden tiger's splinter.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for identifying irony
 - 1 mark for explaining its significance

12. Which literary device is used in 'The Tiger King'? Explain with an example.

- **Answer:** Satire is used to mock blind faith in astrology and authoritarian rule. Example: The Maharaja's obsession with tiger hunting leads to his downfall.
- **Marking Scheme:**
 - 1 mark for identifying satire
 - 1 mark for providing an example

Story-Based Questions (3)

1. Why did the Maharaja decide to kill 100 tigers?

- The astrologers predicted that the king would die due to a tiger. Determined to defy fate, he vowed to kill 100 tigers, believing that eliminating them would secure his survival. His obsession with tiger hunting became his defining goal, leading him to impose strict rules on hunting and manipulate circumstances to achieve the count.

2. How did the British officer's request influence the Maharaja's decisions?

- A British officer expressed a desire to hunt tigers in the kingdom. Fearing it would interfere with his vow, the Maharaja refused permission but arranged expensive gifts to appease the officer. This incident highlights his desperation to control every aspect of tiger hunting and protect his personal mission.

3. What was the irony in the Maharaja's death?

- The Maharaja killed 99 tigers, believing he had fulfilled his vow. However, the hundredth tiger was not killed by him but remained alive. Ironically, his death came from a splinter in a wooden tiger, proving that fate had ultimately triumphed despite his efforts to avoid it.

Value-Based Questions (3)

4. What lesson does the story teach about blind faith in astrology?

- The Maharaja's downfall illustrates the dangers of blindly believing in fate. His obsessive tiger hunting controlled his actions, leading him to ignore logic and justice. The story critiques superstition and highlights how people often make irrational decisions due to blind faith.

5. How does the story emphasize the reckless exploitation of nature?

- The Maharaja's ruthless killing of tigers for personal security demonstrates human disregard for wildlife. His actions contribute to the extinction of tigers, showing how unchecked hunting and selfish motives lead to environmental destruction.

6. What does the Maharaja's obsession reveal about power and authority?

- His belief in controlling fate reflects the arrogance of rulers. Instead of governing wisely, he misused his power for personal desires. The story warns against the abuse of authority and shows how self-centered leadership can lead to downfall.

Competency-Based Questions (4)

7. How did the Maharaja manipulate circumstances to complete his vow?

- He banned others from hunting tigers, ensured that the count remained intact, and personally arranged expeditions to kill more. When fewer tigers were found, he married into a kingdom with a higher tiger population to fulfill his goal, demonstrating his obsessive determination.

8. How did the failure to kill the hundredth tiger lead to his fate?

- The Maharaja believed he had killed the hundredth tiger, but it had survived. His ignorance of the truth allowed fate to intervene, ultimately leading to his accidental death by a wooden tiger's splinter—proving that destiny cannot be altered.

9. What does the story reveal about irony and fate?

- Despite believing he had outwitted fate, the Maharaja met his end exactly as foretold. The irony is that his efforts to prevent death only ensured its arrival in an unexpected manner, reinforcing the theme that fate is inevitable.

10. How did the Maharaja's priorities affect his governance?

- Instead of focusing on administrative duties, the Maharaja became consumed by tiger hunting. His obsession led to harsh laws and manipulative actions, proving that poor leadership driven by selfish motives can harm a ruler's kingdom.

Literary Device-Based Questions (2)

11. How does satire play a role in *The Tiger King*?

- The story satirizes the blind belief in fate and arrogance of rulers. The Maharaja's extreme measures to prevent his death, only to be killed ironically, highlight the absurdity of superstition and authoritarian rule.

12. Explain the symbolism of the wooden tiger in the story.

- The wooden tiger symbolizes fate's triumph over arrogance. Though harmless in appearance, it becomes the instrument of the Maharaja's death, reinforcing the inevitability of destiny and mocking his futile attempts to escape it.

Section C: Long Answer Questions

1. Theme-Based Question

How does *The Tiger King* explore the theme of fate versus free will?

Answer:

Introduction: The story *The Tiger King* revolves around the idea of fate and free will, illustrating the Maharaja's desperate attempt to escape destiny. The astrologer's prophecy foretells his death by a tiger, but the king tries to defy it through his obsessive hunting.

Content - Para 1: The Maharaja exercises his free will by killing tigers, banning others from hunting, and manipulating circumstances. His belief in controlling destiny drives every decision. However, his actions are dictated by fear rather than rationality, making his obsession ironic.

Content - Para 2: Despite all efforts, fate triumphs when he dies due to a wooden tiger's splinter. The unfulfilled vow of killing the hundredth tiger reflects destiny's inevitability. The story critiques blind faith and excessive arrogance, proving that fate has its own course.

Conclusion: Through irony, *The Tiger King* suggests that fate and free will exist in conflict, but human arrogance often accelerates destiny rather than altering it.

2. Value-Based Question

What moral values does *The Tiger King* highlight regarding arrogance and environmental destruction?

Answer:

Introduction: *The Tiger King* serves as a cautionary tale, showcasing the consequences of arrogance and reckless environmental exploitation. The Maharaja's belief in controlling fate leads to the merciless killing of tigers, highlighting selfishness and blindness to responsibility.

Content - Para 1: The king's obsession with hunting stems from his arrogance. He disregards governance in favor of hunting, punishing those who interfere. His pride prevents him from acknowledging reality, ultimately leading to his downfall.

Content - Para 2: His actions also reflect environmental destruction. By killing tigers indiscriminately, he accelerates ecological imbalance, showing how humans exploit nature

for personal gains. The story warns that excessive greed and disrespect for wildlife can have grave consequences.

Conclusion: The story instills moral values about humility, rational thinking, and the need for environmental conservation, emphasizing that recklessness leads to self-destruction.

3. Article-Based Question

Write an article on how *The Tiger King* reflects political authority and dictatorship in rulers.

Answer:

Introduction: Political authority, when misused, can transform rulers into dictators driven by personal motives rather than governance. *The Tiger King* is an allegory that critiques authoritarian leadership, portraying the Maharaja's obsession with hunting as symbolic of unchecked power.

Content - Para 1: The Maharaja imposes ruthless laws, banning others from hunting tigers while he relentlessly pursues his own goal. His decrees are absolute, and any opposition results in severe punishment. His rule lacks diplomacy, showing how personal agendas override governance.

Content - Para 2: His dictatorship affects not only his kingdom but also nature. Just as autocratic rulers exploit people, the Maharaja exploits wildlife. His downfall serves as a metaphor for leaders who ignore wisdom in pursuit of self-serving ambitions.

Conclusion: The story subtly criticizes tyrannical rulers who prioritize personal goals over responsibility, showing that reckless authority inevitably leads to failure.

4. Speech-Based Question

Write a speech on how blind faith in prophecies affects rational thinking, using *The Tiger King* as a reference.

Answer:

Introduction: Respected audience, today I speak on how **blind faith in prophecies clouds rational thinking**. Many people shape their lives around beliefs rather than reasoning, and *The Tiger King* provides a prime example.

Content - Para 1: The Maharaja's entire existence is dictated by a prophecy. Instead of ruling wisely, he irrationally hunts tigers to escape fate. His misplaced priorities show how blind faith can lead to obsessive decisions.

Content - Para 2: Ironically, his fate unfolds exactly as predicted, proving that excessive reliance on astrology can be harmful. The story warns against irrational fears and encourages logical decision-making.

Conclusion: Superstition and fate are abstract ideas, but reason and wisdom should guide our actions. Blind belief without questioning limits progress.

5. Story-Based Question

How does *The Tiger King* portray irony through the Maharaja's actions?

Answer:

Introduction: Irony plays a crucial role in *The Tiger King*, exposing the paradox between the Maharaja's actions and his ultimate fate. The story builds suspense through irony, making the Maharaja's death both humorous and tragic.

Content - Para 1: The king kills tigers to escape his foretold death, but in doing so, he rushes towards it. His obsession makes him reckless, ignoring warnings and logic. His overconfidence creates the irony that ensures his downfall.

Content - Para 2: Despite believing he has altered destiny, he meets his end through a **wooden tiger**, proving that fate is inevitable. The irony highlights how blind arrogance can backfire, shaping his life into a mockery of his own belief.

Conclusion: The irony reinforces the theme that destiny cannot be manipulated, teaching that excessive pride only leads to self-destruction.

6. Author's Point of View-Based Question

How does R.K. Narayan's storytelling style enhance the message in *The Tiger King*?

Answer:

Introduction: R.K. Narayan's satirical and ironic storytelling style plays a crucial role in delivering the message in *The Tiger King*. He subtly critiques human arrogance while using humor to highlight serious themes.

Content - Para 1: Narayan builds a dramatic and exaggerated narrative around the Maharaja's obsession. His light-hearted tone makes the king's reckless actions entertaining while still exposing their foolishness.

Content - Para 2: Through irony, he ensures the message is deeply impactful—while readers enjoy the satire, they also recognize the moral lessons. His simplicity combined with wit ensures accessibility, making the story memorable.

Conclusion: Narayan's distinctive storytelling ensures that the satire remains engaging, while the deeper themes of fate, arrogance, and governance resonate powerfully.

7. Complex Analytical Question

How does *The Tiger King* criticize human obsession with control and power?

Answer:

Introduction: The story critiques the human tendency to **control fate, nature, and people**, portraying the Maharaja's desperation to dictate outcomes. His obsession with avoiding death turns into an ironic tragedy, proving the failure of absolute control.

Content - Para 1: The Maharaja believes eliminating tigers will ensure his survival. His thirst for control leads him to disregard logic, sacrifice governance, and manipulate circumstances. The irony emerges as his obsession blinds him to the reality of destiny.

Content - Para 2: His death by a **wooden tiger** reinforces the failure of his control. The moment he believes he has conquered fate, it strikes back in an unexpected manner. The story warns that excessive control often accelerates destruction rather than preventing it.

Conclusion: Through satire and irony, *The Tiger King* exposes the flaws of absolute control, proving that destiny cannot be controlled and arrogance leads to downfall.